PRACTICE 01 · 10-MINUTE

The Overwhelm *Practice*

Overwhelm→Grounded

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	Any time	Beginner	4

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Overwhelm is the feeling of having too much happening at once. Too many thoughts, tasks, or emotions asking for attention at the same time. It pulls you forward into what needs to be done, what might go wrong, what can't be dropped.

Nothing is wrong with you. Your system is responding to carrying a lot. This practice is here to help you come back into the present and create a little space again.

> *"I am safe in this moment."*

A note before you begin. This practice only works when you actually do it, not when you read about it. The shift happens in your body, not in your head. Trust what you feel during it, even if it surprises you. Your body, mind, and intuition are all part of this. Let them lead.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

Optional: Lavender, bergamot, or frankincense essential oil. Choose one and inhale gently before you start. It signals to the nervous system that something is about to shift.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> This practice works in sequence. First naming what's happening in your mind, then moving it through your body, then returning you to the present. Each step builds on the last. Don't skip ahead.

1	Thought Work	2 min
2	EFT Tapping	6 min
3	Gratitude	1 min
4	Close	1 min

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

2 MINUTES

Get curious. This is a judgement-free zone.

Before we move the emotion through the body, we name it. Emotions don't come out of nowhere. They're often driven by a thought, belief, or quiet pressure running below the surface. You don't need to fix anything here. Seeing it clearly is enough. Clarity creates space.

Sit comfortably. Take one slow breath.

In your journal, answer honestly:

- What am I feeling right now?
- What thought might be creating this feeling?
- Is there a quiet pressure running underneath it?

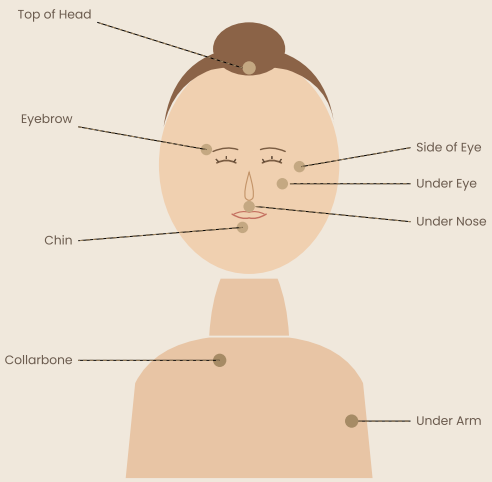
Write 1–2 honest sentences. You don't need to solve anything. You're putting words to what's already there. That alone creates space.

02 EFT Tapping

6 MINUTES

EFT (Emotional Freedom Techniques) involves tapping specific acupressure points on the face and body while staying present with the feeling you identified in step one. Research shows it reduces cortisol measurably. The mechanism is direct: tapping these points sends calming signals to the amygdala, interrupting the stress response at its source. I've found Brad Yates to be one of the clearest and most grounded guides for this work. His videos are ones I return to myself.

EFT TAPPING POINTS



Brad Yates · EFT Tapping for Overwhelm

YouTube · ~6 minutes · Opens in new tab

Watch →

Hold the thought or feeling you identified in step one while you tap. You don't need to say every word perfectly. Just stay present until it ends. If the charge softens, notice it. If it doesn't, that's okay too.

03 Gratitude

1 MINUTE

Simple and honest. That's all it takes.

This isn't about pretending the overwhelm wasn't real. It's about shifting your nervous system from a threat orientation toward the present. Genuine gratitude, not forced, changes what your brain is scanning for. Your body follows.

> Write down 3 things you're genuinely grateful for right now. They don't need to be significant.
>
> **Examples:**
>
> - Someone close to you who supports you
> - Having food, shelter, or a place to rest
> - Something you did today that supports your life
>
> Once you've written them, take one breath. Let the sensation settle in your body, not just your head.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Set the tone for what comes next. Place one hand on your heart. Choose one statement that feels steady and believable right now. Not aspirational, just true.

"I'm allowed to take this one step at a time."

"I don't need to carry everything at once."

"I support myself today."

> Take one slow breath to seal it. Then gently return to your day.

PRACTICE COMPLETE

Overwhelm often comes from living too far ahead.

Today, you chose to come back to yourself. You don't need to hold everything at once. Return to this practice whenever the weight starts building again. It takes less time each time you do.

Creating inner balance, one small pause at a time.

ENJOY YOUR DAY